

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

Tuesday, July 14, 2026

Edition No. 4

Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

ECONOMY

U.S. Consumer Prices Expected to Drop as Gas Prices Fall

On July 14, 2026, the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics will release the Consumer Price Index (CPI), which measures the average change over time in the prices paid by consumers for goods and services. Analysts predict that the inflation rate, which is the general rise in prices, will decrease due to a significant drop in gas prices following a recent peace agreement between the U.S. and Iran.

Source: Kiplinger

This news is important for everyday people because lower inflation can lead to more stable prices for everyday items, making it easier for families to budget their expenses. If inflation decreases, it may also influence the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) to keep interest rates lower, which can affect loans and mortgages.

MARKETS

U.S. Stock Markets Drop Due to Middle East Tensions

On July 13, 2026, U.S. stock markets closed lower as tensions between the United States and Iran escalated. The Dow Jones Industrial Average, which tracks 30 large U.S. companies, fell by 138.37 points (0.26%), while the S&P 500, an index of 500 large U.S. companies, declined by 60.05 points (0.79%). The Nasdaq Composite, which focuses on technology stocks, dropped by 408.43 points (1.55%).

This decline was primarily driven by concerns that the geopolitical conflict could disrupt global energy supplies, leading to higher prices and inflation. For everyday people, this means that rising energy costs could affect their household budgets, making it more expensive to fill up their cars or heat their homes.

Source: China.org.cn

Indian Stock Markets Fall as Oil Prices Rise

On July 14, 2026, Indian stock markets experienced significant declines, with the Sensex, a stock market index that tracks 30 large companies in India, dropping over 500 points (0.7%) to below 77,100. The Nifty, another index that tracks 50 major Indian companies, fell over 150 points (0.6%) to below 24,100. This downturn was primarily due to a sharp increase in crude oil prices, which reached a four-week high due to escalating tensions in the Middle East.

The rise in oil prices raises concerns about inflation in India, which can affect everyday consumers by increasing the cost of fuel and transportation. As prices rise, families may find it harder to manage their budgets, making it crucial to stay informed about these economic changes.

Source: The Financial Express

Federal Reserve Chair to Speak on Economic Issues

On July 14, 2026, Kevin Warsh, the newly appointed Chair of the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates), will testify before the House Financial Services Committee. This is his first congressional appearance since taking office. He is expected to discuss important economic topics, including inflation trends and interest rate policies.

This testimony is significant because the Federal Reserve's decisions can affect interest rates, which in turn influence borrowing costs for consumers. If the Fed raises interest rates, it can make loans and mortgages more expensive for families.

Source: Kiplinger

COMPANIES

U.S. Banks Expect Growth in Business Lending

As major U.S. banks prepare to report their second-quarter earnings, analysts are noticing a revival in business borrowing. This trend is expected to provide new profit opportunities for banks. Increased spending on technology and high-profile initial public offerings (IPOs), which are when companies sell shares to the public for the first time, are driving this growth.

This is relevant for everyday people because if banks are lending more to businesses, it can lead to job creation and economic growth, which can positively impact the job market and wages.

Source: The Financial Express

Major U.S. Banks to Report Earnings Amid Optimism

On July 14, 2026, major U.S. banks, including JPMorgan Chase and Bank of America, are set to release their second-quarter earnings reports. Analysts expect positive results due to stronger equity trading and underwriting revenues. Equity trading refers to buying and selling stocks, while underwriting involves banks helping companies raise money by issuing new shares or bonds.

This news is significant because the performance of these banks can provide insights into the overall health of the economy. If banks are doing well, it can indicate a stable financial environment, which can benefit everyday consumers.

Source: Investment Executive

Understanding the Impact of Middle East Tensions on Oil Prices

The recent tensions in the Middle East, especially between the U.S. and Iran, have led to significant increases in global oil prices. The Strait of Hormuz, a crucial waterway for oil transportation, has become a focal point of these tensions. Disruptions in this region can lead to supply shortages, causing oil prices to spike.

This topic is important because higher oil prices can contribute to inflation, which is the general rise in prices of goods and services. For everyday people, this means that they may face higher costs for fuel, transportation, and everyday goods.

Source: Reuters

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF · Edition No. 4

Generated by AI · Not financial advice

Tuesday, July 14, 2026